

Collects and Biographies for

Saints' Days & Festivals

of the Scottish Episcopal Calendar

May

Using this booklet

This booklet contains a short biography, and appropriate collects, for all saints and dated festivals within the Scottish Calendar published in 1996. It does not provide Post-Communion Prayers.

You may use the short biography as a preface to the Collect of the Day to introduce the life of the saint to the congregation, or as a short homily.

This booklet is arranged with one saint (or festival) to a page, giving details of the saint's day, its category (1-6) and the liturgical colour. Collects for use at a 1970 Scottish Liturgy (or 1929) Eucharist are given on the left, those for 1982 Scottish Liturgy on the right.

Notes

- Where feasts in Category 4 fall on a Sunday (other than a Sunday in Categories 1 and 2), they may, if local circumstances require, be kept on that day.
- When days in Category 6 coincide with a day of higher category, they should be omitted that year.

Key to Abbreviations

CCP	Celebrating Common Prayer (Society of St Francis)
ECUSA	Episcopal Church of the United States of America
F	Black Letter Saints' Days (W.H. Frere; SPCK, 1961)
MEG	Malcolm E. Grant, The Revd. Canon
R	The Roman Missal (1970)
SA	An Anglican Prayer Book (Church of the Province of Southern Africa) 1989
SEC	Scottish Episcopal Church Alternative Collects
SPB	Scottish Prayer Book 1929, as amended in 1967

Credits

Originally compiled by the Reverend Canon Malcolm E Grant, and used at the Cathedral of St Andrew, Inverness. This version was edited and repaginated by the Reverend Gareth J M Saunders, Edinburgh, June–October 2003. Additional material was taken from *Exciting Holiness*, Second Edition, 2003.

Version 2.2

1 MAY

Philip and James, Apostles [4] *Red*

Philip is mentioned in all the lists of the apostles and John's Gospel supplies a few details about him. He came from Bethsaida, brought Nathaniel (usually identified with Bartholomew) to Jesus, assisted at the Feeding of the Five Thousand, and was the disciple approached by some Greeks who wished to see Jesus. Later details about him are obscure, and he has often been confused with Philip the Deacon. The most likely account suggests that he preached the Gospel in the Phrygian area of Asia Minor, and died, possibly as a martyr at Hierapolis in modern Turkey.

James the son of Alphaeus is listed among the apostles, and is often known as 'James the Less' to distinguish him. In later times he has often been identified with James, the Lord's brother, and leader of the Church in Jerusalem. In Mark's Gospel the name Alphaeus is given as the patronymic of Levi or Matthew, so it is possible that these two apostles were brothers. Nothing else is known of James.

Philip and James are celebrated on the same day because the church in Rome, where their relics were laid to rest, was dedicated on this day in AD 560.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,
whom truly to know
is everlasting life:
grant us perfectly to know
thy Son Jesus Christ
to be the way, the truth, and the life;
that, following the steps
of thy holy Apostles,
Saint Philip and Saint James,
we may steadfastly walk in the way
that leadeth unto everlasting life;
through the same thy Son
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty Father,
whom truly to know
is eternal life:
teach us to know your Son
Jesus Christ
as the way, the truth, and the life;
that we may follow the steps
of your holy apostles
Philip and James,
and walk steadfastly in the way
that leads to your glory;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SEC)

2 MAY

Athanasius, Bishop and Teacher of the Faith (373) [6] *White*

Born at Alexandria in AD 295, as a deacon he accompanied his bishop, Alexander, to the Council of Nicaea in 325, where the Arian heresy was condemned. Three years later he was elected to succeed Alexander, and his episcopate was dominated by the conflict with the Arians, who denied the divinity of Christ, and who had the support of several emperors. He was banished several times.

Most of his important writings in defence of orthodox teaching date from a period of peace in the middle of his 45-year episcopate. The final years of his life were a time of tranquillity, and he devoted himself to repairing the harm done to the Church by the years of dissension and violence. He died in 373, one of the greatest teachers of the faith of all time.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Grant us, we beseech thee,
Almighty God,
that, as Saint Athanasius
contended with constancy
for the integrity of the faith,
so we may both believe in our hearts
and confess with our lips
the true nature of thy Consubstantial
and Incarnate Word,
even Jesus Christ thy Son our Lord,
who liveth and reigneth with thee
in the unity of the Holy Spirit
one God, in glory everlasting.

(F)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Everlasting God,
whose servant Athanasius
courageously testified
that Jesus Christ is truly with us
in the Word made flesh:
grant us so to see
the glory of your Word
and to grow into his likeness,
that we may be fulfilled
in the knowledge of you,
the only God;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

8 MAY

Julian of Norwich (c.1413) [6] *White*

Little is known of the life of Mother Julian, who lived for many years as an anchorite (hermit) in a tiny cell attached to a small church in Norwich. She was a mystic who, on 8 May 1373, received a series of 15 revelations in a state of ecstasy lasting several hours. One further vision followed on the next day, and after twenty years meditating on this experience she wrote her famous book, *Revelations of Divine Love*. She died around the year 1413.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Most holy Lord,
the ground of our beseeching,
who through thy servant Julian
hast revealed the wonder of thy love:
grant that as we are created
in thine image
and restored by thy grace,
so our wills
may be made one with thine,
that we come to see thee face to face
and gaze on thee for ever;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(Julian Shrine – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Most holy Lord,
the ground of our beseeching,
who through your servant Julian
revealed the wonder of your love:
grant that as we are created
in your image
and restored by your grace,
our wills may be
so made one with yours,
that we may come to see you
face to face
and gaze on you for ever;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(Julian Shrine)

12 MAY
Thomas Rattray, Bishop (1743) [6] *White*

Thomas Rattray came of a long-established Perthshire family, and was distinguished for his theological writings while still a layman. As a liturgical and patristic scholar he exerted a major influence on the development of the Scottish Liturgy, and was a staunch defender of the retention of primitive liturgical practices in worship.

During the Church's struggle to free itself from the claim of James, the Old Pretender, to appoint bishops, Rattray was a leader among those who contended that the appointment of a bishop belonged properly to the clergy of the diocese and required the approbation of the laity. His election as Bishop of Brechin in 1727 was declared null by the College Bishops, but he was appointed Bishop of Dunkeld some time later, and Primus in 1739. He died in 1743, one of the most learned prelates of his time, and himself an example of the primitive piety and strictness of life that he laboured to restore among those committed to his charge.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Eternal God,
who didst call thy servant
Thomas Rattray
to a life of piety and pastoral zeal,
and didst strengthen thy Church
through his teaching:
keep thy people faithful
to the teaching of our Saviour
Jesus Christ,
and transform our worship
with the fire of holy discipline
and love;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Eternal God,
you called your servant
Thomas Rattray
to a life of piety and pastoral zeal,
and strengthened your Church
through his teaching:
keep your people
faithful to the teaching
of our Saviour Jesus Christ,
and transform our worship
with the fire of holy discipline
and love;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

14 MAY
Matthias, Apostle [4] *Red*

Matthias was chosen by the remaining eleven apostles in the days between the Ascension and Pentecost to fill the vacancy among their number caused by the defection and death of Judas Iscariot. Some have argued that they acted in haste, and that Saul of Tarsus was to be the replacement apostle. Be that as it may, Matthias was chosen by lot, but nothing further is known of him. Yet the qualification required for this ministry of witness to our Lord's resurrection was companionship with Jesus, and these remain valid expressions of the purpose of Christian discipleship and the only true means by which it can be fulfilled.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,
who into the place
of the traitor Judas
didst choose
thy faithful servant Matthias
to be of the number
of the twelve Apostles:
grant that thy Church,
being alway preserved
from false Apostles,
may be ordered and guided
by faithful and true pastors;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who in the place of the traitor Judas
chose your faithful servant Matthias
to be of the number of the Twelve:
preserve your Church
from false apostles,
and, by the ministry
of faithful pastors and teachers
keep us steadfast in your truth;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(SEC)

21 MAY
Helena (c.330) [6] *White*

Helena was the wife of the Roman Emperor, Constantius Chlorus, and mother of Constantine. It is not certain when she became a Christian, but her son, on being proclaimed emperor at York in AD 306, treated her with great honour, and after toleration was extended to the Christian religion Helena devoted all her influence to its promotion.

In old age, in the year 326, Helena made an extended visit to the Holy Land, where she did much to relieve the poor, and where she founded churches on many of the sacred sites. Traditionally her name has been associated with the discovery, close to Calvary, of the actual Cross on which our Saviour suffered.

In the Eastern Church she is commemorated on this day, together with her son Constantine.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Gracious Lord,
who hast built up thy Church
through the love and devotion
of thy saints:
grant us grace to follow
in the steps of thy servant Helena,
as she sought to follow
in the steps of thy blessed Son,
and fill our hearts
with love for thee and others
for His sake;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SA – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Gracious Lord,
you have built up your Church
through the love and devotion
of your saints:
help us to follow in the steps
of your servant Helena,
as she strove to follow in the steps
of your Son,
and fill our hearts
with love for you and others
for his sake;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(SA – adapted)

23 MAY

William of Perth (or Rochester) (1201) [6] *Red*

According to tradition, William was a baker from Perth, renowned for his acts of charity. He gave every tenth loaf he baked to the poor, and adopted an abandoned boy and brought him up. On pilgrimage to Jerusalem, in 1201, this youth murdered William on the road between Rochester and Canterbury. Though venerated as William of Rochester, he was never canonized.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
who dost call us ever onwards
to find our perfection in thee:
protect us by thy presence
throughout our earthly pilgrimage,
and bring us safely
to the mansion prepared for us
by thy blessed Son,
our Saviour Jesus Christ,
who liveth and reigneth
with thee and the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
you have brought us near
to an innumerable
company of angels,
and to the spirits
of just men made perfect:
grant us
during our earthly pilgrimage
to abide in their fellowship,
and in our heavenly country
to become partakers of their joy;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(ECUSA)

25 MAY

The Venerable Bede of Jarrow, Teacher of the Faith (735)
[6] *White*

Born in Northumbria in AD 673, Bede was educated under Saint Benedict Biscop, and entered the monastery at Wearmouth, moving after a short time to the twin house at Jarrow, where, as a monk and priest, he spent his whole life.

His Scriptural writings and teaching were influential in their time, and he studied widely among the Church Fathers, but he is remembered principally as an historian, especially as the author of the *History of the English Church and People* – the most complete history of Christian England up to the year 729.

He was renowned for his monastic fidelity and his love of teaching, and was fondly remembered by his pupils, including his biographer. He died peacefully on the eve of Ascension Day in the year 735.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Grant, O Lord,
we beseech thee,
that, as the Venerable Bede,
living his whole life
in retirement from the world,
never ceased his diligence
in prayer and study:
so we, laying aside
all discontent and idleness,
may cheerfully perform the work
which thou givest us to do;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(F)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

We pray you, O God,
that as your Son gave to
the Venerable Bede
grace to drink in with joy
the Word
that gives knowledge of you;
so, in your goodness,
you will grant us to come
at length to yourself,
the source of all wisdom,
and to stand before you for ever;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

26 MAY

Augustine of Canterbury, Bishop (c.604) [6] *White*

Augustine was sent by Pope Gregory the Great in AD 537, with a band of forty monks, to evangelize England. He appears not to have been a particularly confident person and, in Gaul, he wanted to turn back, but Pope Gregory's firm resolution held the group to their mission. The monks finally landed in Kent in the summer of 597, where they were well received by King Ethelbert, whose wife, Bertha, was a Christian, and who soon became a Christian himself, along with many of his subjects.

Augustine was consecrated bishop at Arles, and established his see in Ethelbert's capital, Canterbury, from which, two further episcopal sees, Rochester and London, were established before Augustine's death.

Bede's writings show him to have been a conscientious missionary, but his Roman mission was unable to work with the native British churches in the west and north of the country. He died around the year 604.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

God our Father,
who by the preaching
of Saint Augustine of Canterbury
didst lead the people of England
to the saving knowledge
of the Gospel:
grant that the fruits of his work
may continue in thy Church,
that thy children may follow
the holy doctrine which he taught
and with courage and love
may declare thy Name
unto those who know thee not;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(R & F – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
whose servant Augustine
brought the gospel
to the southern shores
of these islands:
grant that as he laboured
in the Spirit
to bring the Good News of Christ
to your children
so all who hear its joyful message
may strive to make your truth
known in all the world;
through Jesus Christ our Lord
(CCP – adapted)

31 MAY

The Visit of Mary to Elizabeth [5] *White*

The church today recalls the visit of Mary to her cousin Elizabeth, as Luke's gospel records. The celebration of the feast first occurred at a Franciscan Order General Chapter in 1263 but quickly spread throughout Europe. Since it is a celebration clearly described in the gospel, the churches of the Reformation were less inclined to proscribe it than they were other Marian feasts, particularly as it was the occasion for Mary to sing her great hymn of praise in honour of her Lord and God. Just as Luke sees John's leaping in Elizabeth's womb as the first time John bears witness to Christ as the promised Messiah. Thereby he links the old covenant with the new. He seems to be saying that just as the old covenant clearly points to Jesus, so does its last prophet, yet to be born.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God, who didst lead
the Blessed Virgin Mary
to visit Elizabeth,
to their exceeding joy and comfort:
grant to us thy people,
that as Mary did rejoice
to be called the Mother of the Lord,
so we may ever rejoice
to believe the incarnation
of thine only-begotten Son:
to whom with thee
and the Holy Ghost
be all honour and glory,
world without end.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Mighty God,
by whose grace Elizabeth
rejoiced with Mary
and greeted her
as the mother of the Lord:
look with favour
on your lowly servants
that, with Mary,
we may magnify your holy name
and rejoice to acclaim
her Son our Saviour,
who lives and reigns with you,
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(SEC)

May

1	Philip and James, Apostles	4	Red
2	Athanasius, Bishop and Teacher of the Faith, 373	6	White
3	—	—	—
4	—	—	—
5	—	—	—
6	—	—	—
7	—	—	—
8	Julian of Norwich, c.1413	6	White
9	—	—	—
10	—	—	—
11	—	—	—
12	Thomas Rattray, Bishop, 1743	6	White
13	—	—	—
14	Matthias, Apostle	4	Red
15	—	—	—
16	—	—	—
17	—	—	—
18	—	—	—
19	—	—	—
20	—	—	—
21	Helena, c.330	6	White
22	—	—	—
23	William of Perth (or Rochester), 1201	6	White
24	—	—	—
25	Bede, the Venerable, of Jarrow, Teacher of the Faith, 735	6	White
26	Augustine of Canterbury, Bishop, c.604	6	White
27	—	—	—
28	—	—	—
29	—	—	—
30	—	—	—
31	The Visit of Mary to Elizabeth	5	White